ETCSL 2.1.7 — The building of Ninĝirsu's temple (Gudea, cylinders A and B)

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- **Editors:** ETCSL project (Black, Cunningham, Robson, Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006; editors Black, Zólyomi, Cunningham; composite text after Edzard 1997 (RIME 3/1, E3/1.1.7.CylA, CylB, pp. 68–101) and Krecher 1995–96 (electronic); translations consulted Jacobsen 1987, Falkenstein 1953; commentary Suter 1997, 2000, Hurowitz 1992, Zólyomi 1999 (XML header). Tablets: Cylinders A and B (copy TCL 8).
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.2.1.7 ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.2.1.7 ; ORACC epsd2/royal and ETCSRI **Q000377** (`../../ORACC/epsd2-royal--Q000377--Gudea-Cylinders/`, `../../ORACC/etcsri--Q000377--Gudea-Cylinders/`).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-20 from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/`).
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Content

Gudea, ruler (*ensi*$_2$) of Lagaš (c. 2125 BCE), builds the E-ninnu, the temple of Ninĝirsu at Ĝirsu. **Cylinder A** (30 columns, 812 lines kept + 4 lost): Enlil's decision; Gudea's dream; the journey to Nanše, who interprets it; the second dream and the god's own description of his house; extispicy, the purification of the city, the brick mould and the first brick; the materials brought from the mountains (cedar, stone, metals); the building, the stelae, the furnishing; colophon "the middle hymn". **Cylinder B** (24 columns, 488 lines kept, about 59 lost): the god's entry into the finished house, the installation of the divine household (counsellor, gatekeeper, chamberlain, musicians, herdsmen, farm manager, fisheries inspector, ...), the seven days of feasting in which the master and the slave are equal, Ninĝirsu and Bau at the banquet, the blessing of Gudea; colophon "the last hymn". A first cylinder (the "cylinder X" before A) is lost; fragments are disputed.

Files

- `c.2.1.7.xml`, `t.2.1.7.xml` — ETCSL TEI source.
- `transliteration.md` (1,300 lines; each line `N. A1.1 …`, N = ETCSL's running composite number, `A1.1` = cylinder A column 1 line 1), `translation.md` (prose paragraphs labelled with composite ranges) — conversions by `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Line numbering

ETCSL's **`A<col>.<line>`** = **Edzard 1997 (RIME 3/1)** column and line = ORACC `A i 1` – verified line by line by `../../../בניין-המקדש/temple_tools.py conc GU` (1,300 = 1,300, all labels equal; concordance in `../../../בניין-המקדש/1-גליליות-גודאה/concordance.md`). The running composite numbers 1–1363 skip lost lines: 387–389 (A xv 1–3), 457 (A xvii 4), 1248–1253 (B xix 6–11), 1264–1275 (B xx 1–12), 1285–1300 (B xxi 1–16), 1306–1319 (B xxii 2–15), 1326–1336 (B xxiii 2–12). The literature cites the cylinders by column and line (e.g. "Cyl. A ix 10"); so do we (`A.ix.10`).

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for `בניין-המקדש/1-גליליות-גודאה/`. ETCSL's English is rank 3 (complete); ETCSRI's English (rank 3; after Edzard 1997, partial) is in the ORACC folder.